



Eat smart: To be the best you have to invest in the discipline of doing what no one else does! Like Novak Djokovic, whose dietary discipline, mental grit and longevity are matched by none in the present era. GETTY IMAGES

another adaptogenic herb that is believed to help the body manage stress. It can be consumed in powdered form, as a supplement, or added to warm milk.

Chamomile: Chamomile tea is popular for its calming properties. It can help relax the muscles and soothe the mind. Enjoying a cup of chamomile tea before bedtime may promote better sleep.

Lavender: Lavender is known for its soothing aroma. You can use lavender essential oil in a diffuser, add a few drops to a bath, or even apply it to your pillow to help induce relaxation.

Amla (Indian gooseberry): Rich in Vitamin C, amla is known for its antioxidant properties and may help the body to cope with stress. Consuming it in various forms, such as fresh fruit or juice, can be beneficial.

Peppermint: Peppermint is not only refreshing but may also have calming effects on the digestive system, indirectly contributing to a sense of relaxation. Peppermint tea

is a commonly favoured option.

Cardamom: Cardamom is a spice that is not only aromatic but may also have mild sedative properties. Adding it to your tea or incorporating it into cooking can be a delightful way to enjoy its benefits.

Nutrient-Rich Foods for Enhanced Mental Health in Athletes:

Omega-3 Fatty Acids: Found in fatty fish, chia seeds, flaxseeds, and walnuts, Omega-3 supports brain cell structure, reduces inflammation, and contributes to mental resilience.

Complex Carbohydrates: Whole grains, sweet potatoes, and legumes provide sustained glucose release, fueling both physical activities and stable blood sugar levels crucial for mood and focus.

Lean Proteins: Chicken, turkey, tofu, and fish supply essential amino acids vital for the production of neurotransmitters, influencing mood and supporting mental well-being during training and recovery.

Colourful Fruits and Vegetables: Organic berries, leafy greens, and

citrus fruits offer antioxidants that combat oxidative stress, promoting cognitive function and overall mental well-being in athletes.

Probiotics and Fermented Foods: Found in homemade curd, kefir, fermented veggies and night-old dosa batter, probiotics foster a healthy gut microbiome, potentially impacting mood regulation and providing an extra layer of mental resilience.

Nuts and Seeds: These tiny powerhouses, like almonds, sunflower seeds, and pumpkin seeds, provide healthy fats and magnesium, supporting optimal brain function and aiding stress management in athletes.

Dark Chocolate: These delightful treats, designed to enhance brain function, have a high cocoa content that provides flavonoids, potentially improving blood flow.

This can enhance cognitive function, offering athletes a mood-elevating treat. Opt for chocolate with 70 percent cocoa content or higher!